17.9 Hydrocephalus and VP Shunt*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Head circumference increasing • Bulging fontanelle • "Sunset" eyes	**ACTUAL** Impaired infant neurodevelopmental organization related to cerebrospinal fluid accumulation as evidenced by an enlarging head, a bulging fontanelle and "sunset" eyes.	• No signs of raised ICP after the shunt is placed.	• Measure head circumference daily. • Position after surgery as ordered. • Watch for vomiting, irritability and a tense fontanelle.	• Outcome reached while he remains stable.
Subjective • Mother asks, "Will my baby be normal?" **Objective** • Parents anxious • Many questions about the future	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety [parental] related to the infant's condition and surgery as evidenced by worry.	• Parents understand the shunt and the plan.	• Explain how the shunt works and the signs that it is failing. • Encourage them to share in care. • Refer to support services.	• Considered met when they show understanding.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Shunt in place	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: implanted shunt.	• Shunt free of infection.	• Watch the wound and temperature. • Teach the parents the signs of infection or blockage: vomiting, irritability, a bulging fontanelle. • Use aseptic wound care.	• Goal reached if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [17], [35], [38]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.